

Senior Program Manager, Violence Prevention – Vital Strategies

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March 11, 2026

Hiring Committee

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Application for Senior Program Manager, Violence Prevention

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Senior Program Manager, Violence Prevention position at Vital Strategies Brazil. As someone who has dedicated the past 10 years to gender-based violence prevention through programs, projects, initiatives, and actions for marginalized populations in Brazil—combined with my lived experience as someone who grew up witnessing domestic violence—I am compelled by the bold mission to reimagine public health declared by Vital Strategies.

Why This Role, Why Now

When I heard about this position, I heard words that made me doubt: "I found a position that seems to be made for you." "Read it! You are the perfect candidate—maybe the only one to fit all requirements." At that moment, I was swimming in pure disbelief. Then I decided to take a look—the classic "can't hurt to try." My disbelief? Gone. Apparently, someone really opened a position as complex as me. Now I write this letter to say hello and confirm that you managed to find that match that was starting to seem like a fictional tale. You decided to post a position made for a very small group of professionals capable enough to fill that role. But as I said, I appreciated the boldness to do it the way it should be done. Only the best of the best are supposed to handle the things that can only be handled by those with the most challenging backgrounds.

Currently, I serve as President Director at UmMaisUm NGO, where I oversee NEDS (Center for Studies in Diversity and Sexuality), our clinical and educational program arm. Through NEDS, I directly manage several key initiatives:

- **Sexual Violence Survivor Support Program:** Trauma-informed care for survivors (6-12 month program with psychosocial assistance, health navigation, and peer support)
- **Healthy Masculinity Program:** Group intervention for boys and young men (13+ years) addressing consent, healthy relationships, and violence prevention
- **Comprehensive Sexuality Education:** Evidence-based curriculum for adolescents including violence prevention and consent education

These programs serve the same population that Vital Strategies targets through its GBV prevention work—predominantly women and LGBTQIAPN+ survivors of violence. My ground-level experience with survivor intake, trauma-informed care, and primary care provides clinical insight that I apply to the corporate side of any business model without hesitation. My career and academic life have evolved so closely, with so many overlaps, that at some point they lost coherence—everything became empty of logic. I lived in both worlds: the clinic and the office. ESG and corporate engagement with social spheres, possibilities to create bridges for better social life—none of this was new to anyone. It was mainstream, trending on Forbes and Harvard Business Review, all over LinkedIn's C-suite. But honestly, that approach never worked. And it still barely works if I try to be optimistic. That feeling of meaninglessness was correct, with a bitter aftertaste when one dares to swallow it.

Addressing a Critical Gap: Primary Care GBV Detection

Your research showing that **only 13% of GBV records come from primary care units** resonates deeply with my experience. At NEDS, we've observed the same pattern: survivors typically present at emergency services only after violence has escalated, missing crucial early intervention opportunities. By the time most cases are first recorded, many women will be closer to their final crisis. Time is the engine that everyone fails to use—and they fail simply because victims have no time to spare. But despite this systemic failure rooted deep in Brazilian culture, solutions exist. They are broken down into trillions of bits of information that we have never learned to use. We won't see progress from any society lost in darkness and ignorance.

I propose that my trauma-informed care expertise, combined with Vital Strategies' technological innovation, could address this issue. I view data management as building blocks layered on top of each other. Our biggest problems with data become apparent when we examine how the layers are stacked. Good data cannot survive bad management. I have experience managing single CSV files across 3 junior analysts and unified datasets in Power BI from 9 different states across Brazil and several European countries. From that experience—filled with meetings, emails, issues, roadmaps, sprints, and agile teams—I can confidently say that all data needs to serve and easily integrate the entire project management framework, and project management needs to serve the people management framework. To keep it simple: any data, datasets, dataframes, dashboards, or data automations that no one understands—or only a small group understands—is just trash with charts and graphs.

Government Partnership Experience

Vital Strategies' work with the Ministry of Health, Conass, and 9 Brazilian cities requires sophisticated stakeholder engagement. At DiverCidade Hub, a small business consultancy I founded a few years ago where I serve as CSO (Chief Strategy Officer), I manage strategic relationships with:

- • **Government stakeholders** at municipal, state, and federal levels
- • **Corporate partners** including Volkswagen Brasil, Fundação Instituto Volkswagen, Rock in Rio, Google DeepMind, and Lollapalooza
- • **Civil society organizations** and educational institutions

And please forgive me for repeating myself when I say that no relationship can survive if all that is brought to the table is conversation. It is precisely that type of evidence-based engagement we need as a society to leave the darkness of ignorance.

Public Health Policy Foundation

While my formal degree is not in Public Health, I have completed multiple specialized trainings directly relevant to this role:

- • **University of São Paulo (USP):** Specialization in Diversity and Social Inclusion in Human Rights

- • **Federal University of Rio Grande do Sul (UFRGS):** National Public Health Policy for LGBTQIA+ Population
- • **USP:** Sexual Education, Health and Wellness
- • **Fadyc:** Postgraduate Specialization in Human Sexuality and Clinical Sexology

I am committed to public health as a field of study—perhaps the most important field in my entire academic journey, from my first day in class to my last time teaching. As you read this, you're absolutely right if some quiet corner of your mind suspected that I am not the type of person to leave such an important conversation reserved only for the university, undisturbed. I didn't. I did the opposite. I dove deeper to understand how our brains constantly shape how we see the world, how we feel it, and the reasoning running inside our minds—but isn't ours to possess, tame, or conquer. I ventured into the complex territory of productivity and performance, and never left until I was ready to sit at the table with entire C-suite executives and explain how public health will always be relevant for business.

Lived Experience as Leadership

I was born in 1997 in Rio de Janeiro, growing up in extreme poverty and domestic violence. This experience shaped my understanding of structural violence, health disparities, and the barriers marginalized populations face when accessing public health systems. Before learning from books, I learned from a woman who became pregnant at 15, gave birth at 16, and was abandoned by everyone at 18, holding a baby who would soon turn 3. She protected me as best she could, but every drop of blood around the place, every scream, every cry was teaching me something—and also consuming something.

I mention this not as a limitation, but as a source of authentic leadership. When Vital Strategies commits to equity, I bring lived experience to that commitment. When the Mental Health Dashboard acknowledges racial data gaps, I understand both the technical and community trust dimensions of addressing them. When ClarIA analyzes 9 million health records, I understand the human stories behind those data points.

I'm not trying to brag. When someone grows as I did, you learn much more about reading people—understanding the subtle shifts in someone's demeanor through their breathing. We learn this to survive, and I'm very good at it. I'm not suggesting I'm exceptional because of my difficult past or that you should compensate me for that. But I'm telling you, as directly as I can, that people with backgrounds like mine are everywhere. Yet few of us reach places like this—universities, international companies, leading projects with budgets of hundreds of thousands.

I am one of the few capable of working across different worlds. It seems you need someone who has walked my path to join you and do the work that I do.

I truly hope this letter brings you some joy, regardless of the reason. And I hope even more that together we can help the women out there find lives free from the taste of blood every night.

I wish you the best. Let's talk soon.